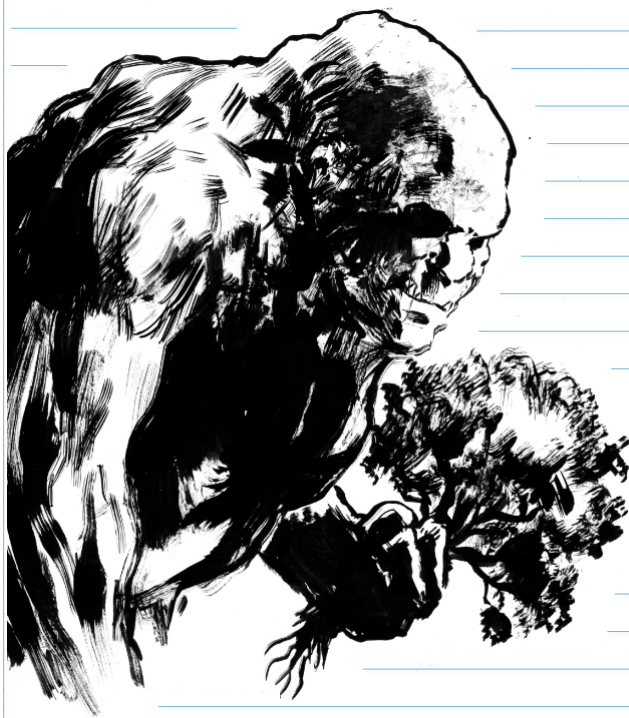


THE SPEAR OF HORRENDOUS IRON

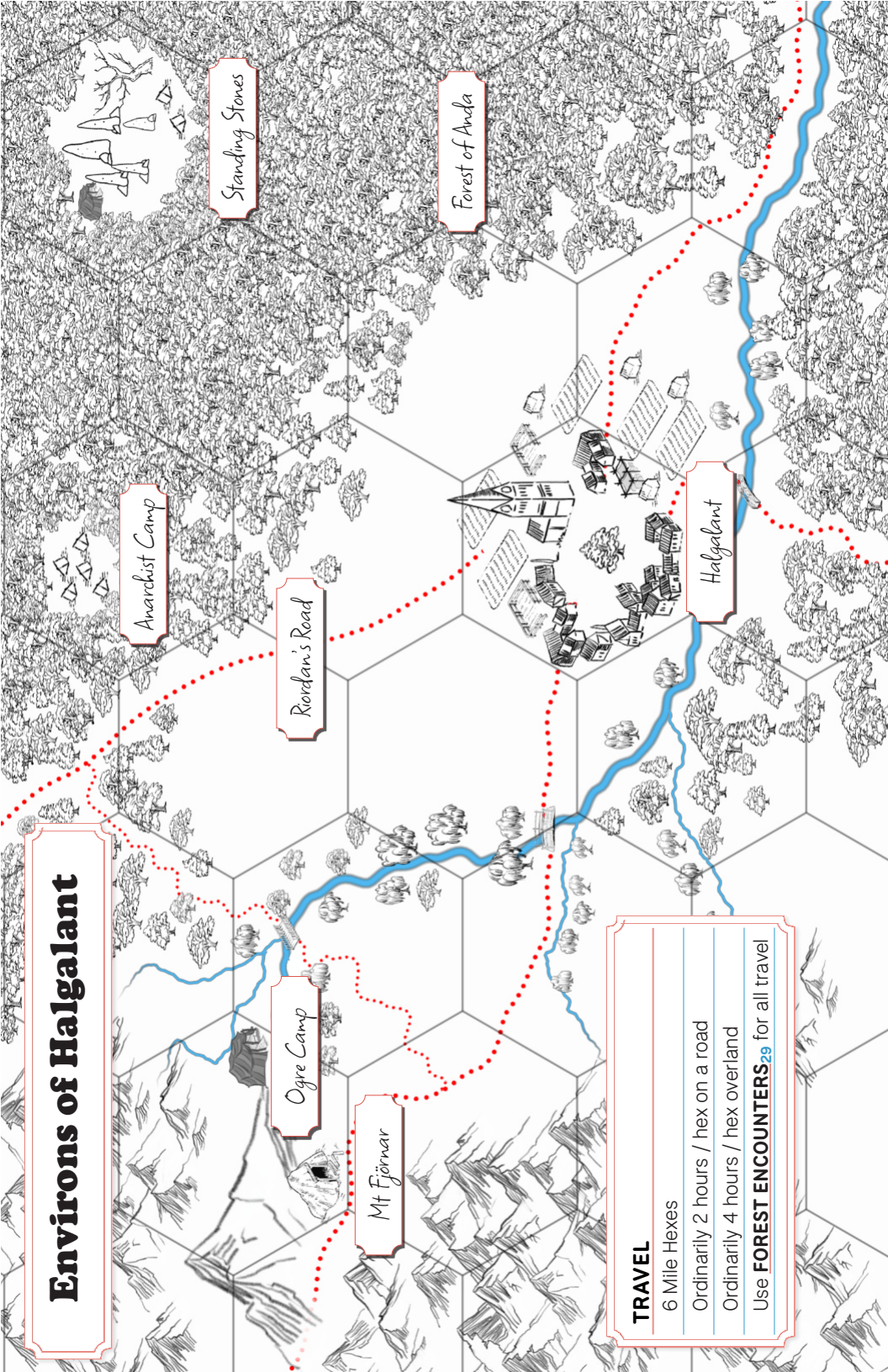
A 3X5 ARCANA JOINT



Designed for use with
ShadowDark RPG



Enviorns of Halgalant



TRAVEL

6 Mile Hexes

Ordinarily 2 hours / hex on a road

Ordinarily 4 hours / hex overland

Use **FOREST ENCOUNTERS**²⁹ for all travel

INTRO

What you got right here is an oldschool-ass dungeon adventure with all the classics: a town with a problem, a forest, and a dungeon.

It's also got devout religious Anarchists, vultures with human hands, a spider in love, professional ogres, eight factions in conflict, a giant, a dragon, an absolutely stupid amount of treasure, and a minimum of obvious solutions.

It's a loveletter to my favorite oldschool dungeon things:

- ◆ A workaday world wrestling with intractable conflicts and strange horrors
- ◆ Problems whose solutions become problems
- ◆ Crawling with choices & consequences
- ◆ Darkness, full of treasure, gunpowder and matches
- ◆ Death, death, death! for the unwary and the unlucky.

The statblocks are for Shadowdark Characters level 5 and up, but with minimal elbow grease, you can run it with any dungeon game.

Get ye into that darkness, ye mad fools!

CREDITS

Writing, Layout, Design, Cartography, etc.

Samuel McClure Taylor

Art. Kim Diaz Holm⁺

patreon.com/kimholm



Fonts. Cocogoose

Letterpress, Cooper*, National Park, Square Peg.

Playtesters. Neal Kirk, Chris Matthews, Joe Waligora, Lindsey Whiting and Wilder Whiting.



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Brian Blade-Breaker and the last of the Giant-Kings

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Designed for use with
ShadowDark RPG



OVERVIEW

THE ANARCHISTS

Have had enough.

THE CULT

Is bringing back their god.

THE GIANT

Forges again the blade that was broken.

THE OGRES

Just want to get paid.

THE PEOPLE

Wait in deadly anxiety, for they know...

THE TAX MEN

Are coming.

THE DRAGON

Sleeps on her silver hoard, dreaming, dreaming.

THE DRUID

Is on her way, sharpening her knives.

HOW IT WAS

Everybody knows: how the Giants once ruled here, eating herd and shepherd alike.

How the Druids — yes, the very Druids themselves! — used to worship dark stones, away off there, deep in the forest.

How Ylvian Blade-Breaker broke the power of the ancient Giant-Kings.

How the valley knew two hundred years of plenty.

How the crafty old Dwarves lived in the mountain after, what wonders they made.

How one night the Dwarves disappeared, like magic.

How the silver dried up.
How times got harder.

How the plain people of Halgalant stayed on. How the Takin saw them through.

How the woods have gotten darker, the rains stranger.

How taxes went unpaid last year. What threats there were.

How there isn't enough.

PEOPLE PEOPLE!

The Town Matters. If the fate of the town doesn't matter to the players, this adventure will lose its heart. The town should matter. Its people are beaten and weary, but good. They need help.

People are Townspeople. Unless otherwise noted, *all* people in this adventure are Townspeople. That includes Anarchists & Cultists.

Whenever a random person is called for, roll on the Townsperson table provided.

Plot Twist! This means dice will reveal familiar people in surprising situations; plotting revolution, dead, or, against all prior indication, Cultists.

These rolls will have a big impact on how the game plays out. This is intentional.

If possible, roll with it.
If not, roll again.

KEY

Notable things are in **bold**.
They're often interactive.

- ◆ **Notable things.** Further details, if any.

CARDS

Mean dice might get rolled.
It's a heads-up when there's a bona fide mechanic or rules interaction.

CREATURE CARDS

Stat blocks for creatures are outlined in red, like this.

The card index on pp 42-43.

A **CARD REFERENCE** indicates a card. If it has no page reference, it's on the page you're looking at.

Page references are in blue, like this¹². **SD**¹² means Shadowdark Core Rules page 12.

Dungeon room references are in red, like this **12**.

STYLE

This is an adventure where player choices should have a defining impact on major events. The world should get weirder as a result of their actions.

But there will always be a few things (maybe several things) that they're going to find really difficult to control. The Travel Times³ (and how they interact with the Clocks⁴³) help enforce this.

The Players' job is to make tough choices about their weird world: where to be, when, and why, and what to do in bad situations.

The GM's job is to make the world weird, the choices tough, the situations bad, and the players well-informed.

HOOKS

KNIGHT'S MAP

Hilda, sole surviving knight of a "Dragon-Slaying" party. Still bloody, shook. She offers a map of the Dungeon (show the players the Dungeon Map) if they can provide her with a horse she can ride away on, today.

She knows there's a dragon and a giant, but not what the Anarchists are up to.

FIRE!

The Town Hall burns.

Faeren²⁰ says she saw Grysa²⁰ light it, who says *he* saw a Goblin¹⁹ do it.

Captain Gythe²⁰ is definitely going to punish *someone*.

He's giving the Townspeople two days to come forward with evidence, confessions, or Goblins.

Failing any of those, Grysa will probably hang.

HIGHWAY BANDITS

A downed tree lies across the road. 9 **GOBLINS**¹⁹ try to rob the players.

6 attack: short bows with **GOBLIN PAIN POISON**¹⁹.

3 sprint in to steal something of value.

They all retreat to the Dungeon³⁴ immediately.

FOUND DEAD

Yahn²⁰ is dead: full of short black arrows. His right foot and **150GP** are buried in a shallow grave in the middle of the road. The horses are untouched. Captain Gythe¹² scratching his head.

THE BLOOD ROOT

Someone rolls up with the **BLOOD ROOT**³⁰ in a jar. Their best efforts do not prevent it from leaving several pools of blood behind. They're here to meet a random Anarchist.

CLOCKS & WEATHER

TOWN CLOCK

- 1 The Town Hall burns. See Hooks₉.
- 2 2d4 **TAX MEN**₂₉ post up on Riordhan's Road, collecting "tolls".
- 3 Roots choke the town well. It's the only well.
- 4 The **DRUID**₂₅ arrives. Asking questions. Planning murders.
- 5 **BLOOD ROOT**₃₀ arrives. See Hooks₁₀.
- 6 4d6 **TAX MEN**₂₉ arrive. Shaky armed resistance. An ugly scene.

FOREST CLOCK

- 1 Trees move in the night, encroaching on the Town.
- 2 Stolen sheep. Dead Shepherd. Saide₂₁ saw an **OGRE**₁₉ herding sheep.
- 3 The forest eats the roads. All Travel Times on roads double.
- 4 Trees grow eyes. Advance all Threat Levels by 1 step.
- 5 The river changes course, and floods the town to 1 foot.
- 6 **THE SUMMONING**₃₃ ritual completes.
HISA₁₇ attacks the **AVATAR OF GEDE**₃₃. Victor: 1-4 Hisa, 5-6 Avatar.

DUNGEON CLOCK

- 1 Full Moon. **CULTISTS**₁₅ worship Gede: starlit bonfire, **TAKIN MASKS**₄₁.
- 2 Goblin funeral. **SNIKTA**₁₈ at the acid pool (9). Bitter, silent tears.
- 3 Awful screaming of a half dozen sheep being eaten alive in Area 21.
- 4 **HISA**₁₇ sleeps off a bender. Dungeon is quiet without her hammering.
- 5 The **SPEAR OF HORRENDOUS IRON**₁₇ is finished.
HISA₁₇ attacks **SKRYLJA**₄₅. Victor: 1-4 Hisa, 5-6 Skrylja.
- 6 Dungeon is empty. Surviving **OGRES**₁₉ methodically loot the hoard.

D6 WEATHER

1. Fair.
2. Drifting Mist. Beautiful. Locals call it *Gede's Smile*. Take 1 luck token.
3. Thick Fog. Visibility limited to Near.
4. Thick Fog. Visibility limited to Near.
5. Drizzle.
6. Thunderstorm. Visibility limited to Near. All Travel Times double.

CLOCKS

The world is in motion around the players. These clocks are tools to keep it in motion.

Advance each Clock by one each sunrise (or when a duplicate encounter is rolled, when indicated on tables).

The clocks don't represent what happens. They represent what happens if the players do nothing.

Rewrite elements of these clocks as your players influence the world.

GM TIPS

Keep it Small. This adventure has a lot of factions, and a lot of possible NPCs. If you need to roll for more Townspeople than are listed, consider making some meet with fatal misfortune. That's too much to track!

Strongly Suggested. Re-roll results on tables indicating violence against Saide or other children, unless your table has discussed it.

MAKING IT SHORT

If you'd like to run this as a one-shot or con game, four easy changes help it sing in a tight frame.

1. **Fewer Factions.** Cut the Tax Collectors, the Druid, and the Goblins. Replace Goblin encounters with 1-2 Ogres.
2. **Clear Evil.** Make the Cultists straight-up evil, mad with cursed tree-sap. Add the phrase *Bring the fall, kill them all* to the poem.
3. **Hooks.** Combine two:
 - ♦ **Knight's Map.** The players are protecting Yahn's yarn shipment when Hilda arrives. The dungeon entrance is visible.
 - ♦ **Ogre Bandits.** While talking to Hilda, 2 bored Ogres attempt highway robbery. They'll retreat to the dungeon if stiffly resisted.
4. **11th Hour.** Start all **CLOCKS** on Day 4. Days 1-3 are the recent events.

THE ANARCHISTS

THE ANARCHISTS

15 Principled People, desperately disillusioned, with bitter ideals of justice.

They believe that long ago, the wicked Druids enslaved the nature god, Gede. They planted rootlings of servitude in her pure, free heart.

They want the real Gede back. They want a wilder, more loving world.

They plan to summon an incarnation of Gede. Hisa will cut the evil roots of servitude from its heart with the *Spear of Horrendous Iron*.

Led by no one person. They have a lot of meetings.

Community Members. When a specific Anarchist is needed, roll on the table for random **TOWNSPEOPLE**²¹.

Joining the Movement. They're recruiting. Conditions for membership might include renouncing all property, an act of religious devotion, or a targeted act of destruction.

ANARCHIST

A commoner in worn clothes.

AC 10, **HP** 4, **ATK** 1 Club +0 (1d4), **MV** near, **S** +0, **D** +0, **C** +0, **I** +0, **W** +0, **Ch** +0, **AL** L, **LV** 1

Property is impossible, because it demands something for nothing.

Property is impossible because wherever it exists, production costs more than it is worth.

Property is robbery.

– Pierre Joseph Proudhon

That we may work in righteousness.

That every one may be fed by the Earth his Mother.

All working together, feeding together, members of one Family; not one Lording over another, but all looking upon each other, as equals.

– The State of Community Opened

THE CULT

THE CULT

A die-hard faction undergoing transformation: bones turn to wood, tongues turn black.

Joining the Cult is an earned position of trust and clout. Some Anarchists want to join. Others feel it's creepy, unhealthy, and elitist.

Deadly Secrets. They don't talk about the location of their camp, or the human sacrifice element of the ritual.

Drugs. They often take the **SAP OF MADNESS**³³.

HEARTWOOD CULTIST

AC 10, **HP** 6, **ATK** 1 Grip +2 (1d4 + life drain), **MV** near, **S** +0, **D** +0, **C** +0, **I** +0, **W** +1, **Ch** +0, **AL** C, **LV** 2

Life Drain. Attach to struck target; 1d4 DMG and Cultist heals 2HP. Auto-hit while attached. DC 9 STR on turn to remove.

Heartwood Limb. At 3 DMG, a **HEARTWOOD LIMB** breaks off: 1:3 Leg, 4:6 arm.

Human Eyes. Not dark-adapted.

HEARTWOOD LIMB

The bone is wood.

Arm. **AC** 9, **HP** 4, **ATK** 1 Grip + 2 (as above) **MV** near

Leg. **AC** 9, **HP** 5, **ATK** 1 Kick +1 (1d4), **MV** close

Human Sacrifice. The ritual summoning of the Avatar of Gede depends on human sacrifice. They're willing to do it, but no one relishes it.

Community Members. If more specific Cultists are needed, roll on the table for random **TOWNSPEOPLE**²¹.

THALDER

Gorgeous. Narcissist. He/him.

Believes Gede will take him as lover when she returns.

Wants the devout to follow in his impeccable, blissful faith.

Plans to father 100 children.

LILJA

Takin herder. True believer. She/her.

Believes only a hardcore revolutionary vanguard can make meaningful change.

Wants Gede to destroy her mind, history to forget her.

Plans to cut Thalder off from the authority he craves.

THE GIANT



HISA

HISA, last Princess of the Giants of Jotungard, is re-forging the blade that was broken, the *Spear of Horrendous Iron*.

She believes that Giants have the right to rule, as in olden days.

She hates humans, deeply.

She wants glory.

She plans on killing Skrylja to test the Spear when finished, and after, that, probably everyone else.

HISA

A four-toed, deep-eyed hulking figure of stone, clothed in lichens and mosses. She sings softly while she works.

AC 17, **HP** 40, **ATK** 2 Hammerstone or 1 Spear or 2 ladle **MV** Near, **S** +4, **D** +2, **C** +4, **I** +1, **W** +1, **Ch** +1, **AL** N, **LV** 8

Hammerstone. +7, Rock (2d6). 3x/day, obliterate a 10' cube of stone.

Brass Ladle. +7, (2d4). DEX DC 15 or be trapped. STR DC 18 or be dragged closer to Hisa.

Spear of Horrendous Iron (if finished). +10 2d12, **Nausea**, **Corruption**.

THE SPEAR OF HORRENDOUS IRON

The blade that was broken, the ancient weapon of the Giant-Kings.

25' long. Intelligent. Utterly evil. Wants to corrupt the gods.

Nausea. When struck: DC 12 CON Save or have Disadvantage on Ability Checks and Attacks until the end of your next turn.

Corruption. If killed, rise corrupted after 3 rounds. You have free will, but are cursed. You cannot cause harm to a giant, can only eat living flesh, and cannot enter under a roof.

SHARDS OF HORRENDOUS IRON

Can be wielded as awkward short swords. -1 (1d6)

Nausea. When struck: DC 12 CON Save or have Disadvantage on Ability Checks and Attacks until the end of their next turn.

THE OGRES

THE OGRES

9 Professional Heavies, strictly in it for the money.

Employed by the Anarchists as protection against increasingly hostile forest beings.

Promised half of Skrylja's Hoard after the "great work" is complete.

Their patience is wearing thin.

Led by **GRAR**.

GRAR

A grizzled vet with small spectacles, a large spear, and zero fucks.

He believes in the merits of professionalism and violence.

He wants what he's owed.

He plans to retire very rich.

THE GOBLINS

13 Crafty Bandits subcontracted by Grar.

The Anarchists tip Grar off to merchant traffic. Grar lets the Goblins rob the merchants.

The Goblins take the heat for everything fishy in the area.

Led by **SNIKTA**.

SNIKTA

Nobody's fool. Watches everything. Brings Skrylja little silver things. Dislikes the Tax Men creeping her turf.

She believes in patience.

She wants to find a fence for all their stolen goods.

She plans on making the brewing Ogre / Anarchist conflict work for her.

STOLEN GOBLIN GOODS

357 skeins of yarn

3 barrels of salt

4 barrels of charcoal

Iron mongery (cookpots, doornails, horseshoes, doornails, axes)

Ivory game pieces

A box of 12 sandals labeled 'Gary'

Value: **835 GP**

OGRE

Massive brutes with tusks and heavy frames. Wearing Chainmail.

AC 12, **HP** 30, **ATK** 2 greatclub +6 (2d6), **MV** Near, **S** +4, **D** -1, **C** +3, **I** -2, **W** -2, **Ch** -2, **AL** C, **LV** 6

GRAR

AC 12, **HP** 38, **ATK** 2 spear +8 (2d6), **MV** Near, **S** +4, **D** -1, **C** +3, **I** +0, **W** -2, **Ch** -2, **AL** C, **LV** 7

Consideration. Spend an Action studying to give the next 2 Attacks ADV.

GOBLIN PAIN POISON

DC 12 CON or disabled, screaming in pain. Save each round to end.

GOBLIN

AC 11 **HP** 5, **ATK** 1 club +0 or 1 short bow (far) +1 (1d4) **MV** Near, **S** +0, **D** +1, **C** +1, **I** -1, **W** -1, **Ch** -2, **AL** C, **LV** 4

Keen Senses. Can't be surprised.

2:6 chance of **GOBLIN PAIN POISON**

SNIKTA

AC 15 (chainmail), **HP** 20, **ATK** 1 spear (close/near) +3 (1d6) **MV** Near, **S** +0, **D** +3, **C** +2, **I** +2, **W** +0, **Ch** +3, **AL** C, **LV** 4

Keen Senses. Can't be surprised.

Wears the *Halfring*.

HALFRING

Ring (cracked). 1/day, 2:6 chance of successfully becoming invisible for 3 rounds.

D6 OGRES

NAME	DESIRE
1. Throgdag	1. FILL
2. Dagthrog	2. FILL
3. Throg	3. FILL
4. Dag	4. FILL
5. Thrag	5. FILL
6. Drog	6. FILL

D6 GOBLINS

NAME	DESIRE
1. Pika	1. More funny things to happen
2. Gibbles	2. A better sleeping bag and more stew
3. Sneet	3. To stop itching!
4. Mizha	4. More nightmares
5. Pierre	5. To pull off the perfect prank
6. Azokabog	6. To know what's behind all the doors

THE PEOPLE

THE PEOPLE

140 hardworking peasants.
Churchgoers, idiots, parents, kids, musicians, cousins, lovers.

They believe a lot of things.

They want to be safe.

SELBYN

Weaver. Secret witch (makes potions). Speaks fiercely. This week, praying. She/her.

Believes something's wrong.

Wants to know why her brother disappeared.

Plans to go into the woods.

CAPTAIN GYTHE

Guard. Considers little; takes action. Fluffy mustache. Loud explainer. This week, bad nightmares. He/him.

Believes in duty and deeds.

Wants Lord Riordhan to notice him.

Plans on running for Lord mayor one day.

THEODA

Farmer. Anxious, stoic. Few Words. This week, pulling weeds. They/them.

Believes something's wrong.

Wants Selbyn to answer their marriage proposal.

Plans to repair the fence.

YAHN

Yarn Merchant. Total jag. This week, says he won't pay the "lazy" workers who "got him robbed" on the road. He/him.

Believes there are two kinds of people in the world.

Wants respect.

Plans on leaving with his money before tax day.

SAIDE

Orphaned, hungry, scrappy nonetheless. Talks a lot. This week, has a cold. She/her.

Believes animals can sometimes talk.

Wants a family.

Plans to do her best today.

Starting Off. 2 Random Townspeople are Anarchists. One is a Cultist.

Random Townspeople, Anarchists, and Cultists. Roll once and read across the Townspeople table, or roll for each item. Roll separately for

TOWNSPERSON

A commoner in worn clothes.

AC 10, **HP** 4, **ATK** 1 Club +0 (1d4), **MV** near, **S** +0, **D** +0, **C** +0, **I** +0, **W** +0, **Ch** +0, **AL** L, **LV** 1

D12 TOWNSPEOPLE

NAME	JOB	WANTS
1. Selbyn	1. Weaver	1. to know why
2. Gythe	2. Guard	2. approval
3. Theoda	3. Farmer	3. an answer
4. Yahn	4. Merchant	4. respect
5. Saide	5. Takin Herder	5. a family
6. Beo	6. Takin Herder	6. revenge
7. Grysa	7. Takin Herder	7. a fresh start
8. Ander	8. Baker / Miller	8. money
9. Starmjorn	9. Thatcher	9. love
10. Relsun	10. Tanner	10. not to be sick anymore
11. Thorfinn	11. Drunk	11. knowledge
12. Faeren	12. Priest	12. to confess

D12 TOWNSPEOPLE BELIEFS

1. Magic isn't real. Hand me that bucket.
2. Magic is a wrongness. Better folk'n you lost their way with it.
3. Magic belongs to Druids. Leave theirs to them, and pray to Gede.
4. Gede is real. She drove the dragons underground, in the old days.
5. Gede is real. And she's forsaken us. Look ye round.
6. Gede is real. I feel her in my bones. ...in my *actual bones*.
7. Riordan won't follow through on those threats. ...Right?
8. Riordan's no worse than any of them Lords. Grow up; pay your taxes.
9. Riordan's the scum of the earth. May the Giants take his bones.
10. The forest is old. Older than Gede. And dark. Dinna seek the stones!
11. Mt. Fjornar? Full of Dwarf-silver. Cursed! Druids cursed it.
12. The Druids are the old school, son. They'll be back. You'll see.

THE TAX MEN

THE TAX MEN

Goons in the employ of Lord Riordhan: an indifferent, sporadically brutal local lord.

They take more than people owe. It's how they get paid.

They believe the world is an awful place; only the hard survive.

They plan on going home and drinking heavily.

TAX MEN

Armed bastards.

AC 15 (chainmail + shield), **HP** 10, **ATK** 1 Longsword +2 (1d8), **MV** near,

S +1, **D** +0, **C** +1, **I** -0, **W** +0, **Ch** +0,

AL N, **LV** 2

ONE

Ex-Con. The vile blows and buffets of the world have so incensed him, he is reckless what he does.

Wants to spite the world.

TWO

Hardened Soldier. Weary with disaster, tugged with fortune. He'll set his life on any chance.

Wants to mend his life, or be rid of it.

THREE

The quiet one. Talks little.

Wants to think the people he hurts can expect no better.

THE DRAGON

SKRYLJA

A reptile who cares only for her beautiful silver dreams. She dragons over a staggering hoard of ancient dwarven silver in perfect darkness.

Sustained by bodily contact with her hoard, she doesn't need to leave this room, and hasn't dragon' in decades.

She believes she is the most powerful thing in a thousand miles.

She wants what she has.

She will savagely attack any immediate or obvious threat to her silver. Otherwise, menacing, curious, speaks if spoken to, lets anyone pass.

She is totally indifferent to Hisa, the Anarchists, and everything else.

SKRYLJA

AC 16, **HP** 54, **ATK** 2 bite +8 (2d10) or 1 blood breath, **MV** double near, **S** +5, **D** +3, **C** +4, **I** +4, **W** +3, **C** +3 **AL** C, **LV** 11

Blood Breath. Kills you with your own superheated blood. Must first do damage with a bite. Fills a near size cube extending from dragon. DC 15 CON or 2d10 damage and blinded for 1 round.

Fits easily down all 10' passages. Can squeeze through narrower passages at half speed, with some effort.

THE DRUID

THE DRUID

THE DRUID

AC 15, **HP** 31, **ATK** 1 Staff +3 (1d4) or 2 Spell +5, **MV** near,

S +0, **D** +1, **C** +0, **I** +4, **W** +3, **Ch** +0, **AL** N, **LV** 7

Conjure Flames. (INT spell) DC 12. One target in far takes 2d6 damage.

Summon Bear. (INT spell) DC 14. Summon a loyal **BROWN BEAR** that appears within near. It stays for 5 rounds.

Thunderclap. (INT spell) DC 13. Fills a near-sized cube extending from Druid. Creatures within are thrown 2d20 feet in a random direction.

Wears *Boots of the Cat.*

BOOTS OF THE CAT

Jump to a near distance from a standstill. Checks to move silently are always easy (DC 9).

BROWN BEAR

AC 13, **HP** 25, **ATK** 2 Claw +4 (1d8), **MV** near (climb), **S** +4, **D** +1, **C** +3, **I** -2, **W** +1, **Ch** -2,

AL N, **LV** 5

Crush. Deals an extra die of damage if it hits the same target with both claws.

THE DRUID is a nature-worshipping monk from far away. She is of great age and vigor. She refers to the Anarchists as the *Cult of the Unburied Root*. She forgot her own name a hundred years ago. She smiles gently.

She believes that if any incarnation of Gede is summoned and harmed by a re-forged Spear, Gede herself may well be corrupted. This is the vilest blasphemy she can imagine.

She wants to recover the Blood Root and return it to the sacred grove, on a distant island, far to the north.

She plans to kill all the Anarchists.

TOWN OF HALGALANT



"I love this time of day."

THE TOWN

140 souls in 41 buildings in the shadow of Mt Fjörnar, coping with hardships. Among them, the taxes they owe Lord Riordhan.

Robust front-porch culture. Everyone talks.

Sacred Grove. In the center of town, well-attended sunrise and sunset prayers to Gede.

TWO TAVERNS

- ♦ **The Broken Blade.** Known for: an exotic taxidermy collection. Merchants & travellers, wine & pies. Rooms for rent.
- ♦ **The Boar & Bell.** Known for: rude hostility to spellcasters. Locals & families, ales & music. No rooms for rent.

OVERHEARD THIS WEEK

- ♦ I swear to Gede, the forest is eating our farms out there. Never had to work like this to keep the weeds and voles out, never. Don't know how we make it to harvest this year. And with so many young folk up and gone. Not enough hands.
- ♦ How the hell I'm going to get my goods downriver with those Gede-damn bandits out there? And where, I'm asking, are Riordhan's sword men? What are them taxes are for?
- ♦ Listen, kid. Just tell ma, if someday soon, I'm gone, like Lilja, that... nevermind, just don't say nothing. You're a good kid.
- ♦ He said he'd have it here by full moon. Where is he?
- ♦ The river's lost its mind. Dry, then flooding, all week.

D6 TOWN ENCOUNTERS

Roll on this table 1/day. Repeats = advances on the **TOWN CLOCK**₁₀

- 1 **Missing Shepherd.** Their **TAKINS**₃₀ lowing pitifully to be milked.
- 2 **Ivy devours a building.** A crowd gathers; it's fast enough to watch.
- 3 **Traveling Merchant Killed** on the road into town. See Hooks₁₀.
- 4 **Market Day.** Prices crash; there are way too many vegetables.
- 5 4 **TAKIN**₃₀ **run berserk**; 16 **SQUARRELS**₂₉ clawing at their eyes.
- 6 **Head on a Pike.** Murderer & victim (2 random townspeople) are dead.

FOREST OF ANDA



You've heard stories.

THE FOREST

Dense black shadows quiver with life. Not *all* the stories are true.

HURT UNICORN

AC 12, **HP** 20, **ATK** 1
hooves +3 (1d6), **MV**
double near, **S** +3, **D**
+2, **C** +2, **I** +1, **W** +2,
Ch +3, **AL** L, **LV** 4

Broken Horn. Wild
eyed, skittish. Gives
luck token if helped.

TAX MEN

Armed bastards.

AC 15 (chainmail +
shield), **HP** 10, **ATK** 1
Longsword +2 (1d8),
MV near,

S +1, **D** +0, **C** +1, **I** -0,
W +0, **Ch** +0,

AL N, **LV** 2

ROOT BALL

AC 12, **HP** 7, **ATK** 1
devour +2 (1d6), **MV**
close (climb, burrow),
S +3, **D** +2, **C** +0, **I** -
3, **W** -2, **Ch** -3, **AL** C,
LV 3

Dig. Invulnerable
while underground.

Heal. Heal 1d4 DMG /
round while
underground.

SQUARRELS

Lichen, not fur.
Bloody mouths. Big.

AC 11, **HP** 2, **ATK** 1
bite +1 (1d4), **MV**
near (climb), **S** -3, **D**
+2, **C** -2, **I** -1, **W** +2,
Ch -3, **AL** C, **LV** 0

Death from above.
ADV on 1st attack.

FANGED ELK

Will bite if bothered.

AC 10, **HP** 6, **ATK** 1
Trample +1 (1d6) or 1
Bite +2 (1d8), **MV**
Double Near, **S** +2, **D**
+1, **C** +2, **I** -3, **W** -1,
Ch -2, **AL** C, **LV** 3

Trample. DC 12 STR
or knocked down:
Tramples have ADV.

Stampede. 2d4
Tramples as the herd
passes.

WOLVES

AC 12, **HP** 10, **ATK** 1
bite +2 (1d6), **MV**
double near, **S** +2, **D**
+2, **C** +1, **I** -2, **W** +1,
Ch +0, **AL** L, **LV** 4

Pack Hunter. Deals
+1 damage while an
ally is close.

D6 FOREST ENCOUNTERS

Roll a d6. On a 1, there is an encounter.

The Forest during the Day:	Check every 3 rounds	(Unsafe)
The Forest during the Night:	Check every 2 rounds	(Risky)
If a clock increases threat levels...	Check every round	(Deadly)

Treat repeat results on this table as advances on the **FOREST CLOCK**₁₀

1. **HURT UNICORN.** Bleeding, in a Stampede of 4d6 **FANGED ELK**
2. **ROOT BALL.** Carnivorous writhing root-mass. Eating a dead person.
3. **2d4 TAX MEN,** shaking down a wounded **ANARCHIST**₁₃ for a "toll".
4. **2d6 SQUARRELS.** Senselessly furious, chittering shrilly.
5. **1d4+1 WOLVES.** Two of them have human faces. PCs recognize one.
6. **1d2 OGRES**₁₉ escorting 1d6 excited **ANARCHISTS**₁₃.

ANARCHIST CAMP

A ramshackle collection of tents and lean-to's. Well used firepit & communal soup kettle.

A colossal fallen tree makes a rough communal table.

6 **TAKIN**₃₀ graze idly.

1d12 **ANARCHISTS**₁₃ present at any given time.

227 GP buried nearby in a fresh, shallow grave, with a simple wood headstone, reading: *Roots of Evil*.

Relic Prayer. Some of them regularly pause in prayer to recite a mysterious fragment of poem:

*blood of fruit
feet of stone
blood of root
heartwood bone*

It is, in fact, a list of the **relics** needed to complete the **SUMMONING**₃₃

BLOOD OF FRUIT

To grow these fruits, the Cultists have been watering the Gnarled Oak₂₃ with human blood.

Luck token if eaten.
Tastes like mutton.

FEET OF STONE

Must be petrified while living.

The Cultists have gone to great lengths to secure a **BASILISK**₃₇ and a glassy-eyed volunteer.

BLOOD OF ROOT

A beating root of the holy Blood Tree, stolen from a secret grove protected by **THE DRUID**₂₅ hundreds of miles away.

Bleeds unendingly.

HEARTWOOD BONE

As Anarchists become Cultists, their bones turn to roots; any of these wooden bones will serve. One of the Cultists has volunteered to have her arm cut off.

TAKIN

Majestic goats the size of Yaks.

AC 9, **HP** 15, **ATK** 1 Gore +1 (1d8), **MV** near, **S** +4, **D** +0, **C** +3, **I** -2, **W** +1, **Ch** -2, **AL** N, **LV** 1

THE OGRE CAMP

OGRE TRAPS

Tripwire Alarms. An ornate helmet, an axe set with a ruby, and golden bracelet. Each attached to wires that ring hidden bells.

Rock Slides. 3 separate piles of rocks held back by logs. Hand-triggered.

DC 12 DEX or 2d4 Damage. If hit, DC 15 STR or swept into the ravine. DC 12 STR to climb out.

OGRE BALLISTA

2 human-sized creatures (or 1 Ogre) needed to operate.

Takes 1 round to load, cranking loudly.

ATK +3 (2d12), near.

D6 OGRE BOREDOM

- 1 Rock-punching competition
- 2 Learning to read
- 3 Building wagons
- 4 War stories from the fairy wars.
- 5 Gambling: Thieves and Wizards, **SD**₉₄.
- 6 Grumbling: where's the pay - and why's Boss making us build these wagons?

At any given time, 5 of the 9 **OGRES** are at their camp. The other 4 are on guard duty or working actively with the Anarchists.

The Ogre Camp is constructed at one end of a natural canyon. A steep ravine runs alongside it, blocked off at either end with uprooted thorn-bushes.

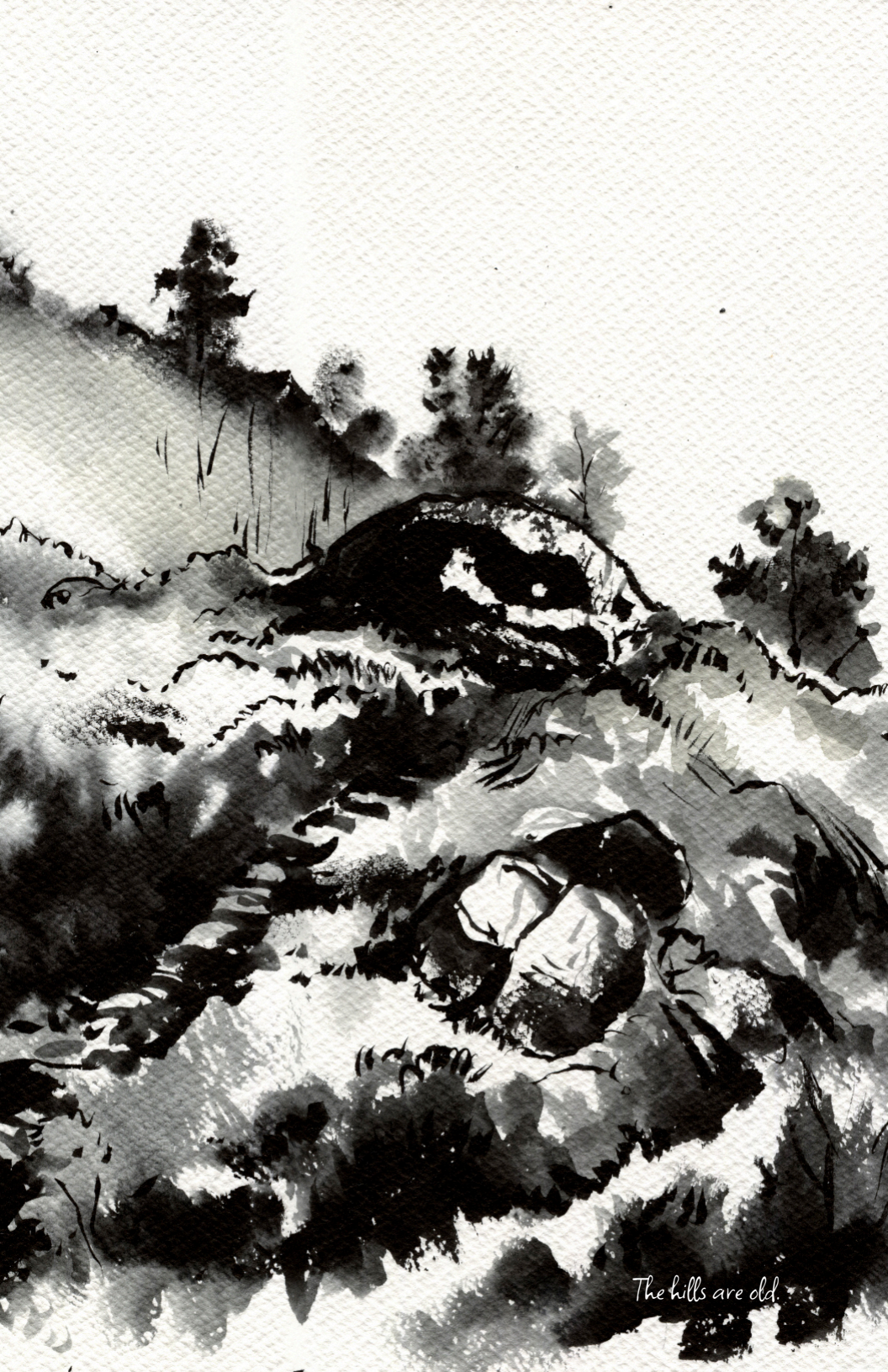
♦ **Behavior.** 1d6: 1-3 watchful, 4-6 **OGRE BOREDOM**.

♦ **Fortified.** **OGRE TRAPS**.

♦ **Strategy.** Liberal but rational with violence. They'll try to knock intruders into the ravine. They'll ransom prisoners if they're rich. If not, they'll take turns throwing rocks at them until they're dead.

♦ **Wagons.** Building 8 three-wheeled rickshaws (1d8 finished), well-suited for traversing mountain paths.

♦ **Ballista.** Not loaded. 12 bolts nearby, neatly stacked.



The hills are old.

THE STANDING STONES

Five standing stones preside mutely over a secret shady dell, the upthrust stone fingers of a long-dead Giant. Huddled close by, two small tents & one larger ogre-yurt.

Above, a spreading Gnarled Oak with no leaves, 3 corpses of human sacrifices tied to it. 1d4 **BLOOD FRUITS**₃₀ growing. Below, a riot of wildflowers.

1 **OGRE**₁₉ & 3 **CULTISTS**₁₅ stay here. By day, bored or sleeping. 3:6 chance that a Cultists is harvesting (and taking) the **SAP OF MADNESS** from the oak. By night, a large bonfire, watchful for the terrors of the forest. If the **FOREST CLOCK**₁₀ > 4, the **BASILISK**₃₇ is here, hooded & chained.

THE SUMMONING

1. Straightforward, heartfelt worship of Gede. 10 min.
2. Burying the volunteers up to their thighs. Tense, reverent. 10 min.
3. **BASILISK**₃₇ unmasked. Attempt at controlled petrification.
Roll Basilisk Behavior: 1:3 as planned, 4:6 chaos ensues.
Roll Volunteer Morale: 1:4 panic, 5:6 steadfast.
4. Lopping off the 2nd volunteer's arm at the elbow.
Roll Volunteer Morale: **1:4** panic, **5:6** steadfast.
5. The tree transforms into the **AVATAR OF GEDE**. 5 min.

If interrupted. The tree transforms into the **OKTAR**.

OKTAR

Dozens of shifting, splitting & reforming roots. No head.

AC 15, **HP** 45, **ATK** 2 Stomp +5 (1d10) **MV** Near, **S** +3, **D** +0, **C** +4, **I** -3, **W** -3, **Ch** +0, **AL** C, **LV** 5

Blind. Senses without sight.

Mad. Attacks targets at random.

Root-whips. DC 15 DEX within close or 1d4 DMG.

SAP OF MADNESS

CON DC 12 or have 2d4 rounds of euphoric nightmare visions; DIS on INT checks.

AVATAR OF GEDE

A 40 foot Dryad, enacting the perfect and mysterious will of Gede.

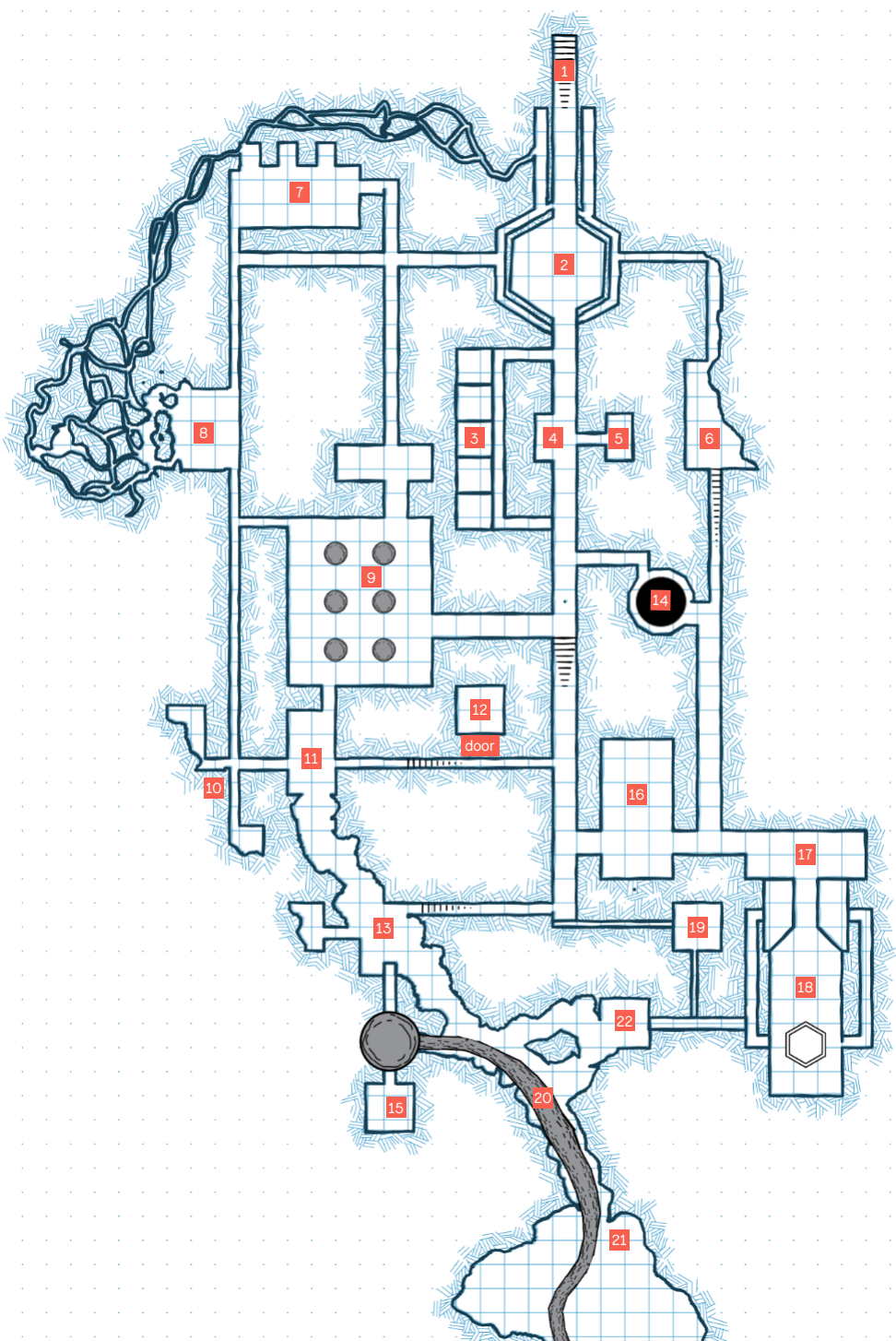
AC 18, **HP** 55, **ATK** 2 +9 Crush (2d8+Life Drain) **MV** Near, **S** +4, **D** +0, **C** +4, **I** +1, **W** +4, **Ch** +3, **AL** N, **LV** 10

Life Drain. Attach to struck target; Avatar heals 8HP. Auto-hit while attached. DC 15 STR on turn to remove.

Bears. After 3 rounds of combat, 3 **BROWN BEARS**₂₅ appear to help.

If corrupted. Within 6 miles of the Avatar, the natural world becomes hostile to intelligent life — wild animals attack on sight, plants burn skin, roots and vines tear down structures. Avatar seeks total destruction of all human habitation.

UNDER MT. FJÖRNAR



HALLS OF THE UNDERKING

Ages ago, before the wars, and the dragon, it was summerhome to the Underking. Agradur, chief among Dwarven smiths, had his anvil here, producing great works of arms, armor, and art.

In the centuries since, Skrylja has dreamed her silver dreams, content to let spiders, rust monsters, stingbats, and things without names crawl in and out of the depths around her.

In this century, the vast majority of the halls are collapsed, closed off, long forgotten, home only to silence and dark.

Last year, by chance, the Anarchists discovered a door to the Upper Halls and later, some of its secrets. They set up operations there. The hardest core among them hatched a plan to bring back Gede. They journeyed over ice and tundra to recruit a Giant.

Last month, dragonslayers reminded Skrylja that a world outside exists. She stacked their blood-filled armor neatly. Now she broods.

This week, Hisa blasted a tunnel in from area **22**. Now Agradur's forge sings again as Hisa re-forges the Spear. Dark roots invade in piles and tangles to split what walls remain. Feverish Anarchists in weird masks plan the approaching **SUMMONING**³⁵.

D6 DUNGEON ENCOUNTERS

Roll a d6. On a 1, there is an encounter.

The Dungeon during the Night:	Check every 3 rounds	(Unsafe)
The Dungeon during the Day:	Check every 2 rounds	(Risky)
If a clock increases threat levels...	Check every round	(Deadly)

Treat repeat results on this table as advances on the **DUNGEON CLOCK**¹⁰

1. **2 ROOT BALLS**²⁹ burst from the ceiling, collapsing a nearby passage.
2. **1d6 CULTISTS**¹⁵ dancing in violent ecstasy, sweating tree sap.
3. **1d4 OGRES**¹⁹ escorting a blindfolded Anarchist they think is a mole.
4. **2d6 GOBLINS**¹⁹ – roll on **D20 GOBLIN ACTIVITIES**⁵².
5. **3 RUST MONSTERS**³⁶ Burrowing in, through a wall. Draw a new tunnel.
6. **Fight!** Roll 1d6 two more times on this table to see who's fighting.

1. ENTRY

Door in frequent use. **SPEAR TRAP** triggers if the door opens fully. A rock wedged behind the door currently disables it.

2. FOYER

MURDER-HOLES concealed by geometric carvings. Secret Door to the NW, faint footprints on the floor.

3. SLEEPING QUARTERS

1d6 **ANARCHISTS**₁₃ occupying them at any given time. Mending clothes, arguing economic theory, or making out.

If Searched: 34 GP, hidden in a sock.

4. WARDROBE

Shelves, freshly installed. 8 sets of ceremonial Hooded Robes. Coats of 4 **ANARCHISTS**₁₃ hung on pegs.

- ♦ Hooded Robes. Itchy, poorly made. Ogres assume anyone wearing one is a cultist at first glance. Other Cultists, maybe.
- ♦ Coats. Belonging to townspeople. 3:6 chance that one of them recognizably belongs to a character the players have met, if they've been to town.
- ♦ Sleeping **RUST MONSTER** burrowed under the coats.

SPEAR TRAP

DC 9 DEX or 1d6 DMG + **PAIN POISON**

GOBLIN PAIN POISON

DC 12 CON or disabled, screaming in pain. Save each round to end.

MURDER-HOLES

Attacking through the walls: not possible or at DISADV except for crossbow & similar.

RUST MONSTER

Rust brown insect as big as a wolf. Feathery antennae. Consumes metal.

AC 13, **HP** 19, **ATK** 2
Claw +3 (1d6) **MV** near (climb), **S** +2, **D** +3, **C** +1, **I** -3, **W** +1, **Ch** +3, **AL** N, **LV** 4

Corrosive. Metal touching the Rust Monster is destroyed on d6 roll of 1-3

BASILISK

Massive, muscled lizard with six legs.

AC 14, **HP** 25, **ATK** 2
bite +4 (2d6 + petrify),
MV near, **S** +3, **D** +1, **C** +3, **I** -3, **W** +1, **Ch** -3, **AL** N, **LV** 5

Petrify. Any creature that touches the basilisk or meets its gaze, DC 15 CON of petrified.

CLOAK OF ELVENKIND

Hooded, billowing cloak that shifts colors to match its surroundings.

Benefit. Your checks to hide are always easy (DC 9). 1/ day, become invisible for 5 rounds. Invisibility ends if you attack or cast a spell.

GIANT SPIDER

Bulbous abdomen and eight spindly legs.

AC 13, **HP** 13, **ATK** 1 bite +3 (1d4+poison) **MV** near (climb) **S** +2, **D** +3, **C** +0, **I** -2, **W** +1, **C** -2 **AL** N, **LV** 3

Poison. DC 12 CON or paralyzed for 1d4 hours.

DARKMANTLE

Floating black octopus with rows of red eyes.

AC 13, **HP** 4, **ATK** 1 bite +3 (1d4) or 1 darkness, **MV** near (fly), **S** -2 **D** +3 **C** +0 **I** +0 **W** +0 **C** -3, **AL** N **LV** 2

Darkness. Extinguish all light sources in near.

5. BASILISK STORAGE

Heavy wooden door, barred from the outside. Small curtain covers a grate at eye level in the door. Leaning in the hallway, two six foot poles ending in hooks, one bloody. Awful stench. Inside, a petrified woman, a functional **CLOAK OF ELVENKIND** around her shoulders. Waiting at the door, a hungry **BASILISK**.

6. EMPTY

Collapsing. Fine dust, unused for decades. Faint warm draft from 13.

7. KITCHEN

Smells of stew. In one pantry, pickled meats in clay pots. Flesh-eating bioluminescent maggots got in. In another pantry, the stolen **GOBLIN GOODS**₁₈.

8. HALF ROOM, HALF CAVE

The north door is marked in Goblin: *NO! GIANT SPIDER* & a **DARKMANTLE** in a tender partnership: a love-language of dark death. The ceiling: worked in webs, artfully, intricately: the story of their love.

A pale **Dead Man**, sucked dry of blood, clutches a small **chest of gold (175 GP)**, and a **faintly glowing Sword**.

The sword is non-magical; the spider painted it with bioluminescent maggot blood. The dead man came with Hilda to slay the dragon. An unlit, **half-burned torch** lies nearby.



'Acid Pool

ACID

Touch: 1d6 Damage

Quickly dissolves all but bones, brass, and glass.

WINE

DC 9 WIS or drink again.

DC 9 CON or DISADV on ability checks for 10 min / each failed CON.

HOTSPRING

1d4 Damage for each round spent submerged.

GELATINOUS ICK

AC 11, HP 9, ATK 1
tentacle +2 (1d6), MV
near, S +1, D -3, C +0, I
-4, W -3, Ch -4, AL N,
LV 1

Trapping. DC 12 STR or
sucked inside on a hit.
Escape: DC 12 STR.

TAR PIT

If lit on fire: within 2
turns, smoke renders
the entire dungeon
uninhabitably deadly for
3 days. Denizens pour
out, universally furious.

CHALICE (MEAD)

Drinking grants a luck
token which is lost if
you speak. Cup refills
every hour if
submerged. Denser
than water.

9. ST. MARIAN'S POOLS

Lush, carpeted with young ferns, growing thickly in the perfect dark.

Ceilings: 50', finely mosaiced.

Pools: 15' deep, ringed with hip-high brick.

Day. **HISA** comes here every 10 minutes (1:6 chance she is here), crouching in area **11**. Her arm and great **brass ladle** enter to fetch things. Ladle reaches all pools.

1. **ACID.** Bubbling, bright red. Sharp smell. Hisa etches spear-runes with it. Effective latrine, used frequently. **Brass key** (to area **12**) and two **brass earrings** just visible among a **pile of bones**.

2. **WINE.** Deep red. Ogres are strictly forbidden from drinking it. Hisa drinks it.

3. **HOTSPRING.** Sulfur smell, whitish crust: Hisa traps livestock in it with her ladle to cook them.

4. **GELATINOUS ICK.** Clearish, gelatinous, moving very slightly. Goblins feed this sticky, hungry slime superstitiously. Suspended, a shining **Longsword +1**.

5. **TAR PIT.** Bubbling, black, highly flammable. The **Mithral Crown of the Underking** (fabulous cultural and monetary value) forgotten at bottom. Hisa uses the tar to fuel the forge.

6. **Tomb of Silence.** Under clear, still water, a stone sarcophagus carved with a woman's peaceful smiling face. Inscription, in dwarven: *St Marian the Content*. On top, a **CHALICE** filled with delicious mead. The cup's magic is tied to the tomb. Value: **50 GP**



Takin Mask

10. COLLAPSED

Two empty rooms, largely collapsed.

11. EMPTY ROOM

The floor is heavily marked with black tar and acid marks.

12. CULTIST ALTAR

PINK FLOWERS

Smell delightful.

1 Stat Damage healed for every ten minutes spent here.

TAKIN MASK

I don't know what these do, but I love the art, which is a good reason to include them.

Whatever your table needs that this module doesn't have, make the Takin Mask do it.

Maybe it's part of how Cultists transform.

Maybe you can summon and command d6 **TAKIN**₄₃ to arrive in d6 rounds, which obey you for d6 rounds.

Maybe it confers stranger powers than these, at a terrible cost.

Maybe it's just a mask.

A rough stone slab with weird markings.

A perfect circle of beautiful **PINK FLOWERS** dangling on roots from the rough ceiling. Tall candles lit, soft light.

If the **DUNGEON CLOCK**₁₀ > 3, a random **TOWNSPERSON**₂₁ is dead on the altar, wearing a weird **TAKIN MASK**.

Under the mask, their mouth is stuffed with rich earth, green shoots beginning to grow: their eyes are open, peacefully smiling, but their arms are battered and bloodied with struggle. Fingers are turning to wood.

13. PASSAGE

Footprints of old chambers can still be detected, but Hisa recently blasted out this entire area. Hisa uses it as a passageway to the Pools of St Marian (9). Her path between 11 and 22 is stained with tar and pitted with acid damage.

14. BOTTOMLESS STAIR

ENDLESS STAIRS, narrow, line the edge of a shaft with no bottom. Dry, warm updraft.

Far down, the very faintly glowing entrance of a Tunnel.

From the mouth of this tunnel issues a glowing lavafall, an endless hissing of red-glowing liquid rock falling into the bottomless dark.

The stairs are an old, twofold trap that guards the lava.

- ♦ *None but a hardy dwarf could climb down to the lava and back up!*
- ♦ *Let curiosity be their doom: below is only stairs and darkness, forever. Hahahahahahaha!*

ENDLESS STAIRS

CON roll each 1/2 hour.

3 hours to descend to the tunnel.

5 to ascend from it.

CON DC = # of gear slots carried.

Fail = 1 CON DMG

When under 5 CON, fail also = Stumble

Stumble.

DEX DC 9 or fall.

Rest. The stairs are too narrow and precarious to achieve normal rest.

Connection? The Dwarves of old thought it went nowhere. Were they right?

14A. THE TUNNEL

A very long tunnel. A half a mile or more. Walls of smoothly worked brass. Low ceiling, about 5'.

On one side, a narrow tiled walkway. On the other, a lava duct that ends in the lavafall. Full of bright, hot, flowing **LAVA**.

At the end of the tunnel, a **LAVA SHRINE** blesses the crack in the rock from which the lava flows. A Dwarven Saint, ancient face smoothed by countless pilgrim's touches. Faded inscription, in Dwarven: *Bless our hands, bless our work, bless our tools with the blood of the earth.*

Removing it seals the hole and stops the flow of lava. Replacing it does nothing.

LAVA

Metal arms and armor dipped rapidly in the lava gain a magical +3 bonus for 24 hours.

Metal items left more than a few seconds in the lava melt entirely.

LAVA SHRINE

Value: **450 GP**

Touching it grants a **luck token**.

15. ENCHANTED WELL

A bridge over a deep **well**, where the spur of the river drains. Brass-lined barrels line the walls, empty but sealed.

- ♦ **Well.** Water is always clean and pure. Secret passage Leads to underneath **18**. The first 25 feet of this 5' wide tunnel is completely full of water, letting out into a cramped, crude hall.

16. THE OFFICE

Central Anarchist **MEETING** place.

A toppled statue of the Underking, a sawhorse, and some boards make a large table. On it, maps of the surrounding area and dungeon.

Maps. Allow the players to study both maps (but not the keys).

D6 DUNGEON MEETINGS

In daytime, there is always a meeting of **ANARCHISTS₁₅** taking place

- | | |
|-----|--|
| 1-2 | d6 OGRES₁₉ shouting loudly at d6 Anarchists over unpaid wages. |
| 3 | 2d4 Anarchists discussing the ethics of armed resistance to taxes |
| 4 | d4+1 Anxious Anarchists: ...what do we actually <i>do</i> , after liberation? |
| 5 | d4+1 Anarchists playing a board game and sharing stale bread. |
| 6 | d4+1 Anarchists planning details of the SUMMONING₃₃ |

17. ANTECHAMBER

Through an ornate iron grill, room **18** can be seen beyond.



18. THE DRAGON

Sleeping on a staggering **DRAGON'S HOARD** of dull silver, a wingless black dragon, **SKRYLJA**.

Armor and bones of a dozen long-forgotten would-be slayers heaped in one corner, blackened. 1d8 usable armor items (GM choice).

Murder-holes and **hidden passages** repeat the old dwarven defense strategy of room **2**.

Portcullises at either end of the entry hall, triggered by twisting one arm of the throne. Skrylja has forgotten it.

Winches to lift the portcullises in chambers to the sides.

Trap Door. Half-buried in silver. Secret passage to **15**.

SKRYLJA

AC 16, **HP** 54, **ATK** 2 bite +8 (2d10) or 1 blood breath, **MV** double near, **S** +5, **D** +3, **C** +4, **I** +4, **W** +3, **C** +3 **AL** C, **LV** 11

Blood Breath. Kills you with your own superheated blood. Must first do damage with a bite. Fills a near size cube extending from dragon. DC 15 CON or 2d10 damage and blinded for 1 round.

Fits easily down all 10' passages. Can squeeze through narrower passages at half speed, with some effort.

SKRYLJA'S DRAGON HOARD

193,728 Silver Coins. Also, assorted silver chalices, torques, bracelets, rings, etc. Will fill 34 wagons and totally destabilize regional economies.

Magic Dagger, +1 Silver plated. 1/day when it draws blood, magically mutes sound, as *Silence* (**SD₇₁**), for 3 rounds.

Tattered Flying Carpet. Silver threads in beautiful patterns. Fly, double near. Carries 2 human sized creatures and their gear. 1:6 chance / round: move in a random direction while flying. DC 12 DEX to stay on.

Grönjard. Solid silver hammer. Intelligent. Always wants to talk (speaks Dwarven) about the "oldschool" way. Will not under any circumstances allow itself to be used as a hammer.

19. MEDITATION ROOM

A covered **brass keyhole** conceals the **secret door** into this room. Around the lock, telltale scratchmarks of frequent picking. Dappled sunlight with no source fills the room. Soft bird sounds.

Beside an obvious pressure plate, a kitchen chair faces the **MEDITATION WALL**. Next to it, a list of **MEDITATIONS** peek from under a small white rock. 2:6 chance of the **Meditator** being present.

- ♦ **Obvious Pressure Plate.** Stepping on it causes the door to swing softly shut and click, locking from the inside. After 1 minute, the face of St Marian slowly appears in the stone wall, eyes soft and searching.
- ♦ **Chair.** A humble kitchen chair, well used, wobbles, sized to fit a human.
- ♦ **Meditation Wall.** 1/day, St Marian will answer one direct question with unerring truth, using no more than 4 words. If she cannot meaningfully answer, she simply smiles.
- ♦ **Meditator.** A Random **TOWNSPERSON**₂₁. Deep in thought, choosing their next question. Deeply startled to see anyone.

20. THE RIVER

A small channel diverted long ago from the river outside. Hisa has widened the passage all around it.

21. OUTSIDE

The Giant's entrance to the caves. **1:6** chance Hisa is sleeping here (see Hisa's Activities₄₉). Rock debris, flattened vegetation, assorted mangled carcasses. Deep, huge four-toed footprints.

2d6 **VULTURES** peck at a dead sheep. Attack anyone who stays longer than 5 minutes. Individuals retreat if wounded. Always fail Morale checks.

VULTURES

If any **CLOCK**₁₀ > 2, the vultures have human hands, and **AL C**.

AC 10, **HP** 5, **ATK** 1 Tear +1 (1d4), **MV** Near, **S** +1, **D** +0, **C** +1, **I** -3, **W** +1, **Ch** -3, **AL** N, **LV** 1

Carriion Tracker. Can track dead flesh unerringly within 1 mile.

Hands. Picks up rocks or loose gear and drops it from above. +1 (1d4), Near.

MEDITATIONS

Is Sielda cheating on me?

No.

Did Sielda ever cheat on me?

No.

Not even with Ander?

No.

Will my brother ever come home?

No.

— only 1 day, you damn fool! —

What's the point of living, when you'll just die?

— just that damn smile...

Am I a good person?

"Yes, but not always." Ha.

Are the gods real?

Yes.

Have I been seen coming in here?

Do Giants eat people like Susan says?

~~Is the world round like Starmjorn says?~~

Will my crop come strong?

~~How much should I sell my farm for?~~

Will Susan be happier if we move?

Will the Tax Collectors really burn the town if we can't pay?



22. FORGE OF AGRADUR

Agradur's anvil in the center of the room: imposing for a dwarf, diminutive for **HISA₁₇**. A **wall forge** pumps out blistering heat. The forge & anvil are valuable cultural artifacts if correctly identified. (**500GP** each). They were long thought melted by Dragonfire. Otherwise, ordinary.

Ceilings recently blasted out to 25 feet.

Brass ladle, tongs, & other enormous tools lean precariously against the walls.

A **lodge-pine trunk** sticks out toward area 20. Hisa has been using a **Battleaxe** like a pocketknife to strip its branches.

SHARDS OF HORRENDOUS IRON₁₇ stacked on the floor, pulsing with **malevolence**: within near, Lawful characters hear a high pitched ringing. Chaotic characters gain a luck token (once only).

HISA'S ACTIVITIES

4:6 Chance **HISA₁₇** is here with her hammerstone, forging the **SPEAR OF HORRENDOUS IRON₁₇**. While working at the forge, she sings: rumbling, lilting: like timpany drums being played with crushed gravel.

If she is not present, roll again, as follows:

1:6 chance she is sleeping. She sleeps for 2d6 x 10 minutes at a time in area **21**. She sleeps *in* the river, to cool herself. Area **20** floods to 4 feet until she wakes. In sleep, she resembles a rocky hillside (indistinguishable until within Close distance), and blocks the lower half of the cave entrance.

Otherwise, she is temporarily absent from the dungeon, and will return in 1d6 x 10 minutes.

She frequently quenches the spear in the river, **20**. When here, she is gone for 3 rounds. This produces thick clouds of steam, obscuring vision for d6 rounds.

She often walks to area **9** for ladlefuls of tar, for the forge. At night, she goes there for ladlefuls of wine, for her self. When gone to area **9**, she is gone for d6+2 rounds.

UNDER MT. FJÓRNAR

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D20 GOBLIN ACTIVITIES

1. Sitting on another Goblin, poking them.
2. Counting silver coins *very* carefully
3. Preparing meat for stew
4. Eating stew
5. Wondering aloud what to do when the Ogres start killing Cultists
6. Wondering aloud if Skrylja can be disabled for any length of time
7. Using the bathroom in area **9**
8. Preparing to ambush an incoming Merchant's wagon
9. Deciding: ransom or cook this **Random Townsperson**₁₇?
10. Playing Wizards & Thieves (**SD**₉₄)
11. Rehearsing a flattering religious ritual to perform for Skrylja
12. Playing *Rock Net Knife* to decide whose lookout turn it is
13. Discussing whether or not road traffic in this area is played out
14. A risky game of keepaway with an iron pot & a rust monster
15. Trying to retrieve the brass key in area **9**
16. Trying to pick the lock on area **12**
17. Refusing an Anarchist's demand to feed the lizard in area **5**
19. Talking quietly with Skrylja, giving her silver coins.
20. Stealing everything and getting out.

Get ye into that darkness, ye mad fools!

